Muncie Policy Memo

Civic Meeting Report

Parks Board Meeting October 20, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VgQacz_8mxc
Publication Date	2026-10-20T23:00:56Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Muncie Parks and Recreation Board Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: October 20, 2026
Body: City of Muncie Parks and Recreation Board

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the regular monthly meeting of the City of Muncie Parks and Recreation Board to order at 00:00:05.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Present:** Ashley, Damon, DJ (plus presiding officer/chair).
  - **Absent:** Brian Mark.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance led by the board 00:00:15.
- **Approval of Minutes:** Handled later in the meeting under new business; the board separately approved the minutes from August 18, 2026, and September 15, 2026 00:04:41.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- 00:00:53 **Superintendent<U+2019>s Report**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone, Superintendent.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Superintendent Malone provided updates on storm recovery efforts focusing on McCulloch, Cowan, and Westside parks, noting significant tree and brush removal work. Splash pads have been winterized (except Halteman, which awaited a weekend event). Updates were given on Northside Park (underway via community development), Westside Park, Till Pond (site walk-through completed noting future maintenance needs for mowing and weed eating), Allshire Park (mulch installed, playground painted with Ball State hospital volunteer assistance, new shelter added), and Halteman (building renovations, parking lot painting, and track maintenance). Additionally, the search for a new program director is moving through final HR checks, and planning for the 2027 five-year master plan is underway.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no vote taken.
- 00:19:04 **Special Event Proposal: Tuhey Park 5K Walk/Run (November 14, 2026)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone / Presented via staff application submitted by Michael Carroll (Care Cats).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed an application for a 5K and 1-mile walk/run at Tuhey Park scheduled for November 14, 2026. Board members expressed concerns regarding the very late notice (application received same-day), lack of clarity on a representative attending, and missing details regarding security, permits, insurance, vendor lists, and parking logistics.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None present from the organization.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to **table** the 5K event application to allow staff time to contact the organizers and gather missing logistics 00:25:05.
- 00:25:27 **Special Event Proposal: Back to Muncie Reunion / Muncie Homecoming Festival (July 28 <U+2013> August 1, 2027)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jerry Quarles, Future Choices.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Jerry Quarles presented an overview of the quadrennial community family reunion scheduled for July 28 through August 1, 2027, primarily utilizing McCulloch Park (Cabin 6) and Canon Commons. The event typically draws 6,000 to 10,000 participants and includes food and retail vendors, parades, and staging. Board members emphasized the critical need for robust private and local off-duty police security (recommending 16<U+2013>20 personnel due to the large footprint), proper insurance bond verification, and fee structuring.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Jerry Quarles (Future Choices) spoke on behalf of the event details.

    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to **table** the final approval until next month's meeting to allow the applicant to provide precise security and insurance details with a full board present 00:36:21.
- 00:07:06 **Prairie Creek Report**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Taylor Beard, General Manager (reported by the board via submitted email).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** The report covered replacement pole installations on floating piers, pier winterization deadlines (October 31st with a $100 late fee for unremoved boats), the boat launch bathroom closing for filtration system installation, digital key card access implementation for the North Shore shower house, and FEMA damage tracking. Taylor Beard proposed a $150 pier lease discount for 2027 for leaseholders affected by the 100-year flood or late pier placement, reductions in daily/annual launch fees, and flat rate structures moving forward. Board members expressed support for the rationale but requested a comprehensive long-term budget impact analysis before voting.
    - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Deferred to the November meeting pending receipt of financial sustainability projections.

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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- 00:48:42 **Joe Kucharski (Commodore, Muncie Sailing Club)**
    - Addressed the board to commend the parks department and security measures at Prairie Creek, noting a significant decrease in property damage and fewer incidents with fishermen this season. He also shared historical trivia regarding the Cooper lighthouse at Prairie Creek, noting it was constructed in the 1970s, features an 1860s Civil War-era cannonball at its peak, and its architectural model was inspired by an Old Spice cologne glass bottle produced by Avon.
- 00:53:00 **Aaron Gray (Southside Neighborhood Association)**
    - Announced the upcoming annual kickball and basketball event with community "heroes" (firefighters, police, EMTs) scheduled for one week from the meeting at Ball Corporation Park (Round Macedonia) from 5:30 to 7:30 p.m., expecting 100<U+2013>125 attendees. He raised concerns regarding dark walking track lights, trash can maintenance, and a lack of electrical outlets near the new shelter.
- 00:56:04 **Brian Ellsworth (Store Woods & West Briar Neighborhood Associations)**
    - Appeared on behalf of the Store Woods and West Briar Neighborhood Associations to propose utilizing remaining neighborhood association funds (approximately $2,300 and $3,300 respectively) for park improvements at Store Park. The proposal includes replacing playground mulch with river rock, adding metal edging,

refreshing mulch around pickleball courts, and upgrading the park sign via JC Landscaping.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote to approve the neighborhood association funding proposal for Store Park landscaping 00:01:01.

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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
    - The next regular board meeting is scheduled for **Tuesday, November 17, 2026, at 6:00 p.m.** at City Hall 01:00:51.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned via a motion made and seconded, approved by voice vote 01:00:57.

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